

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Cabinet Mission attempted unity

CABINET MISSION 1946 -> UNITY ATTEMPT, NOT A PARTITION INSTRUMENT

|-- REJECTED -> a sovereign Pakistan

|-- PROPOSED -> Union + groups of provinces + provinces (weak centre)

|-- ACCEPTED (in some form) -> by both parties in June and July 1946

COLLAPSE -> incompatible readings -> withdrawal -> loss of trust -> Partition

RULE -> the Mission is where unity was last available, not where it ended.

MUST REMEMBER: The 1946 elections, Cabinet Mission breakdown, Direct Action Day on 16 August, Interim Government from 2 September, Attlee statement of 20 February 1947 and 3 June Plan led to the Independence Act.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Direct Action Day: call, killings, consequences

16 AUG 1946 -> DIRECT ACTION DAY -> three separable things

|-- POLITICAL CALL -> Muslim League, after deadlock and its own withdrawal

|-- CALCUTTA -> mass killings remembered as the Great Calcutta Killings

|-- LATER REGIONAL VIOLENCE -> separate local actors, triggers and sequences

ORDER -> Direct Action precedes the Congress-only Interim Government (2 Sep 1946)

RULE -> separate call, killings and spread; assign agency to actors, not communities.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Violence of 1946-47 without collective guilt

1946-47 VIOLENCE -> reciprocal waves, regionally specific

|-- NOAKHALI -> BIHAR -> PUNJAB (each with its own actors and triggers)

|-- DRIVERS -> organisations, armed bands, rumour, collapse of policing

|-- REGIONAL SPLIT -> Punjab and Bengal: territorial division and mass violence

 -> elsewhere: political settlement and a minority question

RULE -> agency belongs to organisations and leaderships, never to whole communities.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Two Attlee statements, one deadline

TWO ATTLEE STATEMENTS -> do not conflate

|-- 15 MAR 1946 -> "a minority will not be allowed to place a veto" -> pre-Mission

`-- 20 FEB 1947 -> transfer to responsible Indian hands, not later than June 1948

EFFECT -> a published outer limit converts negotiation into a race against a date

RULE -> one is about the veto, the other is about the deadline.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Mountbatten and the accelerated timetable

MAR 1947 -> MOUNTBATTEN ARRIVES AS LAST VICEROY

DEADLINE -> June 1948 outer limit compressed to August 1947

CONSEQUENCE -> administrative, military and boundary arrangements left incomplete

ANALYTICAL PLACE -> explains execution and disorder, not the choice to partition

RULE -> haste belongs in consequences, not in causes.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: 3 June Plan: a political plan, not an Act

3 JUNE 1947 -> MOUNTBATTEN PLAN -> a POLITICAL plan
|-- ACCEPTS -> Partition in principle
|-- PROVIDES FOR -> division of Punjab and Bengal
| -> referendums in the North-West Frontier Province and Sylhet
| -> boundary commissions
LIMIT -> not an Act of Parliament; transfers no power by itself
RULE -> the political decision precedes the legal enactment of July 1947.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Three partition mechanisms

HOW PARTITION WAS CARRIED OUT -> three different procedures

|-- ASSEMBLY VOTES -> Punjab and Bengal, by the two notional halves of each assembly

|-- REFERENDUMS -> North-West Frontier Province and Sylhet district of Assam

| -> both results took them into Pakistan

`-- BOUNDARY COMMISSIONS -> technical line-drawing, separate from both routes

RULE -> match the province to its mechanism; never swap them.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Indian Independence Act: assent and commencement

INDIAN INDEPENDENCE ACT -> the LEGAL enactment

|-- ROYAL ASSENT -> 18 July 1947 (Westminster)

|-- COMMENCEMENT -> two dominions, India and Pakistan, from 15 August 1947

|-- ALSO PROVIDES -> lapse of British paramountcy over the princely states

SEQUENCE -> 3 June political plan -> 18 July assent -> 15 August commencement

RULE -> assent and commencement are separate legal events.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Statutory commencement versus commemorative observance

WHAT THE STATUTE SAYS

WHAT COMMEMORATION SAYS

both dominions created
from 15 August 1947

Pakistan observes 14 August as its national day
ceremonies at Karachi (14th) and Delhi (15th)

RULE -> statutory commencement is one date; commemorative observance is another.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: The lapse of paramountcy

PARAMOUNTCY -> LAPSED (it did not transfer)

|-- NOT INHERITED -> neither dominion succeeded to suzerainty automatically

|-- CONSEQUENCE -> each state's relationship had to be created afresh

|-- ROUTE -> accession or agreement, negotiated state by state

RULE -> "lapsed" is the operative verb; "transferred" is the error.

CLOSE DISTINCTION: The Indian Independence Act received royal assent on 18 July 1947; transfer dates, Radcliffe Award publication and mass displacement must remain separately dated.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Radcliffe: two commissions, awards of 17 August

BOUNDARY MECHANISM -> two commissions, one chairman

|-- PUNJAB COMMISSION | BENGAL COMMISSION -> chaired by Cyril Radcliffe

|-- COMPOSITION -> equal Congress-nominated and League-nominated judges

|-- DEADLOCK -> members divide -> decisions fall to the chairman

15 AUG 1947 -> transfer of power | 17 AUG 1947 -> awards published

CONSEQUENCE -> border districts uncertain; violence already under way before the line.

EVIDENCE LIMIT: Partition requires League, Congress, British, provincial and popular agency
plus gendered violence and refugee evidence; communal inevitability and single-person blame
are both inadequate.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Responsibility, contingency and the three registers

CONGRESS ACCEPTANCE -> reluctant and pragmatic; deadlock, violence, governability

INEVITABILITY -> structure (1909 onwards) + contingency (dated 1946-47 decisions)

RESPONSIBILITY -> British policy | Muslim League | Congress | communal organisations

-> mass fear and regional dynamics; no single villain

THREE REGISTERS -> legal transfer | political triumph | humanitarian catastrophe

HUMAN COST -> displacement around 10 to 15 million (broad estimate); deaths contested

GANDHI -> in Calcutta and Bengal for communal peace, not celebrating in Delhi

RULE -> record all three registers; a one-sided verdict answers only part.